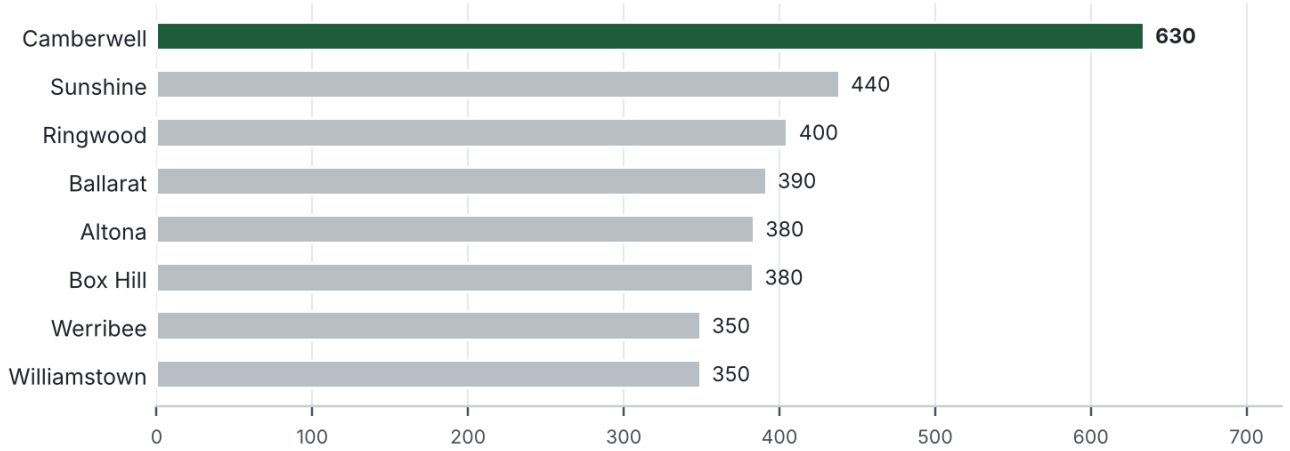
To Belinda Friedman, General Manager, Retail Operations | Date 13 November 2026

From Workforce Planning | Ref WP-04 relief crew placement, Christmas 2026

The relief crew should go to Camberwell this Christmas

Place the 25-person relief crew at Camberwell for the four trading weeks from Friday 27 November to Thursday 24 December. It will work 1,090 hours there, the paid hours of the 215 shifts Camberwell's Christmas roster lists open. Of all eight stores, Camberwell's open shifts are the ones our call-ins would most leave unworked, well clear of any other store's.

Open shifts call-ins would leave unworked if the crew went nowhere



Paid hours of open shifts left unfilled by call-in, 27 November to 24 December 2026 (forecast, no crew placed)

Why not Werribee. Werribee lists by far the most open hours, 3,250, and on last year's fill rates it looks the obvious place for the crew again. But its Christmas roster puts the casuals it took on in February mostly on 8-to-2 and 2-to-6 shifts and lists the extra shifts open from 2 pm and from 6 pm until midnight, straight after them: 100% of its open shifts could be taken by one of its own casuals staying on from a rostered shift. Box Hill (96%) and Altona (79%) have done the same with their evening uplift. Casuals take that kind of offer far more readily than one that needs a separate trip in: since August 2025, 32% of the 2,241 offers that carried on from the casual's own shift at the store were accepted, against 4% of the other 153,829. Our call-ins should fill most of Werribee's Christmas uplift without the crew.

Why Camberwell. Its uplift is daytime work, 9 am to 3 pm on weekdays and morning shifts at weekends. Plenty of casuals are free for it, most of them Box Hill's and Ringwood's university students on their summer break, but none of its open shifts could be taken by a casual staying on from a rostered shift, so every one needs someone to make a separate trip in, most of them to another store, in the busiest month of the year, and few casuals do.

Store	Open shifts	Open paid hours	Could be taken by staying on	Forecast unworked hours
Camberwell	215	1,090	0%	630
Sunshine	240	1,380	57%	440
Ringwood	240	1,140	71%	400
Ballarat	183	880	62%	390
Altona	432	1,770	79%	380
Box Hill	640	2,600	96%	380
Werribee	689	3,250	100%	350
Williamstown	157	640	75%	350

Source: KWS extract WR-26-1187 (12 November 2026); Christmas rosters as published 12 November 2026, 10:00. Hours are rounded to the nearest 10.

Forecast: each casual's answer to a call-in offer fitted as a yes-or-no choice on all 156,070 offers in the extract (the shift's paid hours, time and notice, a sister-store offer, hours already rostered that week, the Christmas weeks, the casual's age band and home store, and whether the offer carried on from the casual's own shift), then run 24 times through the call-in module's offer order and limits over the published rosters, every store's open shifts posted at 09:00 on 16 November and the crew at no store, as WP-04 section 4 counts it. Paid hours are net of the unpaid 30-minute meal break on shifts over five hours (EA 2024). Last Christmas's call-in tables are in relief_crew_xmas2026.xlsx.